



The Middle Ages

Many new kingdoms and empires arose during the Middle Ages. After the fall of the Roman Empire, several kingdoms appeared in Europe sharing a strong belief in Christianity. A new world religion also emerged during the Middle Ages: Islam.

250–950

Maya civilization

The Maya civilization, a collection of competing cities in Mesoamerica, is at its height.



Maya writing carved on bone

711–721

Muslim Spain

A North African Muslim army invades and conquers Spain. The Muslims then move into France but are defeated at the Battle of Poitiers in 732.

700

First American towns

The first towns are built in North America, in the eastern woodlands, by people known as the Mound Builders.

762

Baghdad

Caliph al-Mansur founds Baghdad as a new capital of the Islamic Empire, beginning the “Golden Age” of Islam.

1066

Norman Conquest

The Normans, under William the Conqueror, conquer England. To control their English subjects, they later build many castles.



William the Conqueror leading his men

1095–1099

First Crusade

The First Crusade is a holy war fought by European armies against the Muslims who rule the Holy Land. The crusaders capture Jerusalem, and start Christian kingdoms.

1200–1350

Mali Empire

Growth of the Mali Empire, which conquers Ghana. The capital, Timbuktu, is famed for its wealth and the learning of its Islamic scholars.

1206–1294

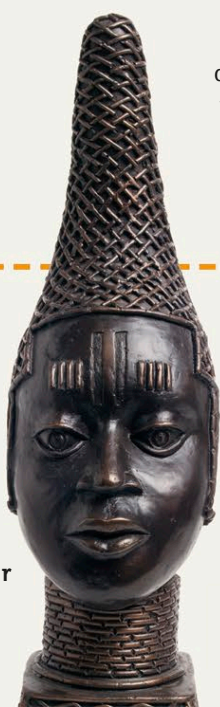
Mongol conquests

The Mongols of East Asia conquer an empire stretching from eastern Europe to the Pacific Ocean. It is the biggest continuous land empire in history.

1440–1473

Benin Empire founded

Reign of Oba (king) Ewuare the Great, founder of the Benin Empire of West Africa.



Queen Mother of Benin

1420–1446

Dome of Florence

The Italian architect Filippo Brunelleschi builds the dome of the cathedral in Florence.

Dome of Florence Cathedral

